

Alexander (Alex) Koyoc

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles

B.A., Linguistics and Psychology

GPA: 3.87 | College Honors | Departmental Highest Honors

Los Angeles, CA

June 2026

Honors Thesis: *“When You Null, You Know: Naturalness Judgments in Mexican Spanish Cataphora”*

Advisor: John Duff

Relevant Coursework: Semantic Theory III; Research Design and Statistical Methods; Neurolinguistics; Semantics I; Linguistic Processing; Syntactic Theory I; Language Processing; Bilingualism and Second Language Acquisition

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Psycholinguistics; formal semantics; sentence processing; anaphora and cataphora; degree semantics; the syntax–semantics interface; Spanish linguistics; bilingualism and heritage languages

CURRENT RESEARCH

Mexican Spanish Cataphora: Self-Paced Reading Follow-Up

University of California, Los Angeles | 2026–Present

Advisor: John Duff

- Developing a self-paced reading study of real-time processing in null and overt cataphora.

Spanish Object-Relative-Clause Processing Project

University of California, Los Angeles | 2026–Present

Advisor: John Duff

- Adapting materials for a Spanish replication of an object-relative-clause interference study.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Language Processing Lab

University of California, Los Angeles | 2025–Present

PIs: Jesse Harris and John Duff

- Administer psycholinguistic experiments involving behavioral and eye-tracking measures.
- Conduct participant intake, eye-tracker setup, calibration, and session monitoring.
- Maintain participant records and follow standardized human-subjects protocols.

Honors Thesis Researcher, Department of Linguistics

University of California, Los Angeles | 2025–2026

Advisor: Jack Duff

- Designed a 2 × 2 naturalness-judgment experiment on null and overt cataphora in Mexican Spanish.
- Programmed the study in PCIBex, recruited participants through Prolific, and analyzed ordinal ratings using cumulative link mixed-effects models in R.

Independent Study Researcher, Department of Linguistics

University of California, Los Angeles | 2025

Advisor: Ethan Poole

- Examined A-movement and A-bar movement through primary theoretical literature and formal syntactic analysis.

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Child Language Acquisition Laboratory

University of California, Los Angeles | 2024

PIs: Megha Sundara and Laurel Perkins

- Assisted with participant-based studies of child language development.
- Prepared study materials, supported research sessions, and maintained laboratory records.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Right Inferior Frontal Gyrus and Late Negation Processing

Neurolinguistics, University of California, Los Angeles | 2026

- Proposed a 2 × 2 rTMS experiment testing the role of the right inferior frontal gyrus in processing post-verbal negation.

GRANTS & AWARDS

Spring 2026: Departmental Highest Honors, UCLA Department of Linguistics

Spring 2026: College Honors, University of California, Los Angeles

2025–2026: Dean’s Honors List, University of California, Los Angeles

2024:	Transfer Research Entry Program Stipend, University of California, Los Angeles
2024:	Mimi and David Chang Centennial Scholarship, University of California, Los Angeles
2023–2024:	Dean’s List, Moorpark College
2022–2023:	Dean’s List, Michigan State University
2022:	Eric Thomas M.A.G.I.C. Scholarship, Michigan State University
2022:	Spartan First-Generation Leadership and Innovation Program Vanderploeg Scholarship, Michigan State University

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Funding Coordinator, UCLA Honors Fellows

University of California, Los Angeles | 2025–2026

- Secured approximately \$1,900 in institutional and catering support for student programming.
- Coordinated funding requests, purchasing, and event logistics with campus partners.

Scholar, First-Generation Leadership and Innovation Program

Michigan State University | 2022

- Participated in leadership programming for first-generation students and spoke with donors about the impact of scholarship support.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Service Team Member, Michaels

Westlake Village, CA | Present

- Assist customers, process point-of-sale transactions, maintain stock organization, and promote the store’s loyalty program.

Sales Associate, Goodwill Industries

Agoura Hills, CA | 2024

- Handled cash reconciliation, supported daily production goals, organized merchandise, and assisted customers.

Bilingual Customer Service Representative, First National Bank of America

East Lansing, MI | 2023

- Assisted clients with loan accounts and payment processing, explained financial procedures, and resolved account-related inquiries.

Cashier, McDonald's

Agoura Hills, CA | 2022

- Processed orders and payments accurately in a high-volume environment and maintained a clean, organized workspace.

RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Experimental Methods: Experimental design, naturalness judgments, self-paced reading, eye tracking, participant recruitment, task administration, and human-subjects protocols

Data Analysis: R, cumulative link mixed-effects models, ordinal regression, Jamovi, data organization, and data-quality monitoring

Research Software: PClbex, Prolific, OSF, Praat, TextGrid, and LaTeX

Programming and Web: HTML, CSS, basic R programming, and GitHub

Languages: English, native proficiency; Spanish, native proficiency